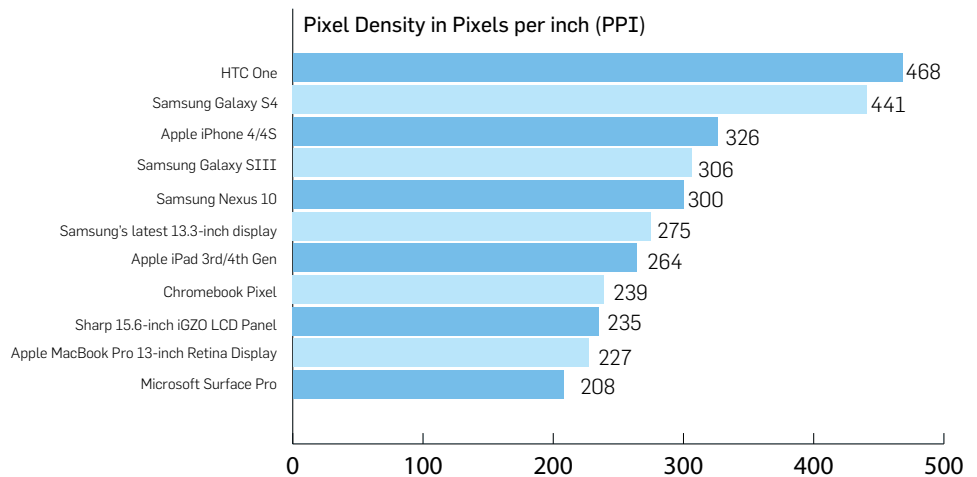


their products run seamlessly on multiple high ppi screens. Same goes for the web designers – making different versions of the same webpage for screens of different resolutions. And god forbid if you are using these high pixel density displays on slower internet speeds – a recipe for pixillated disaster. Companies will always market higher pixel density numbers and it is upto you, the consumer, to decide where to draw the line. Remember, doubling of the resolution equals quadrupling the number of pixels on the device which means a four-fold increase in the video memory required to process and manage the display. Also, hoping to get the absolute best resolution with every application or program you use will be silly as not all programs will be upgraded to the pixel density you are using, at least



not it becomes more mainstream. So be prepared for some pixellated programs (if you use the full screen real-estate) or very

compressed version of regular programs (and when using the programs native resolution) once in a while.

What about eBook readers?



Although the ebook reader market is yet to pick up steam in the Indian landscape, thanks to Amazon's late arrival in India, it is still an interesting product category. With major Indian e-tailers offering ebooks now, it's safe to assume that we are indeed reading more digital books. Of course, a lot of these ereaders are basically tablets and smartphones with a fraction of the people reading ebooks on devices such as the Kindle. Standalone e-ink devices will always be a hard sell in India where people want more out of their gadgets. Only the hardcore book-nerd will go for ereaders. The global trend for standalone ebook readers is going southwards. By 2016, the ebook reader space will amount to just 7.1 million units – equivalent to a loss of more than two-thirds of its peak volume in 2011. (Source: IHS iSuppli Research). Sure Amazon's Kindle Paperwhite is quite an improvement in terms of its response, resolution and the illuminated display as compared to its previous

generation devices. Our experience with local ebook readers has not been that great as these devices have been marred with slow page refresh rates and poor touchscreen response. We have been seeing prototype colour e-ink displays from Mirasol since 2010, but have yet to see a colour ereader. And going by its recent showcase at the SID Display Week 2013, Qualcomm has decided to use Mirasol technology on smart-watches, as a second screen on your smartphone and so on. Plastic Logic, an off-shoot of Cambridge University's Cavendish laboratory, is renowned for its flexible black as well as colour e-ink displays. PocketBook so far is the only player

to have announced an 8-inch front-lit colour e-ink reader, but that will only be available in Russia from next month. Another company called Jetbook have colour ereaders which employs e-ink's second generation colour e-ink screen, but thanks to its appearance being on the grayer side, we haven't yet seen this screen on popular ebook readers. Apart from the numbers, the future definitely is looking grim for standalone ereaders. The need of the hour for this product category some innovation.

The standalone ereaders cannot compete with tablets, but give the consumer a colour e-ink device – most likely one with a flexible screen, good refresh rate, excellent battery life and great visibility in daylight – and who knows – people might just be interested in the category again. Going at the current rate of market adoption of e-ink technology, the only future where it can flourish seems to be in the internet of things space as we are seeing with Qualcomm's Mirasol technology being used on devices other than e-readers. 



Pocket Book